XV: EMBASSY CABLES (EXTRACTS)

The gradual release of American embassy cables, also known as Cablegate, represents WikiLeaks' most high-profile work to date. Around 250,000 cables – short messages by American diplomats around the world on a particular subject, generally around one to two thousand words long – were passed to WikiLeaks by its source. WikiLeaks had released around 20,000 of them by August 2011, initially with its five core partners, but later with an increasingly large coalition of media organisations around the world, now numbering more than fifty.

Unlike the war logs, the cables are written in fluent prose and are meant to convey not only a small number of facts, but also a general sense of wider issues concerning American diplomacy. As such, they are informative not only in what they say, but in how they say it.

The cables presented here demonstrate the extent to which American diplomats saw the interests of large corporations as synonymous with American national interests.